

ENVIRONMENTAL POLLUTION IS AN INCURABLE DISEASE

POLLUTION

IN CONTEXT

KEY FIGURE

Emma Johnston (1973–)

BEFORE

1272 King Edward I of England bans the burning of sea coal in London because of its smoke.

19th century Coal-burning in Britain’s Industrial Revolution stunts growth and raises death rates from respiratory diseases.

AFTER

1956 The UK passes the Clean Air Act, ending the thick smogs that plagued its major cities.

1972 The Clean Water Act is fully ratified in the US.

1984 Toxic gas leaks from the Union Carbide India factory in Bhopal kill thousands and injure many more.

2010 The Deepwater Horizon disaster leaks over 3.19 million barrels of oil into the ocean and affects more than 1,000 miles (1,600 km) of Gulf shoreline.